

Connection closed by foreign host.

Installing and setting up Dovecot

Dovecot is the MDA that will enable the POP and IMAP capabilities. So let's install it:

```
yum -y install dovecot
```

Open the Dovecot configuration file and make the following changes:

```
protocols = imap pop3
mail_location = maildir:~/mail
pop3_uidl_format = %08Xu%08Xv
```

Ensure that the *mail_location* is the same as the *home_mailbox* in the Postfix configuration. Restart and enable Dovecot on start up:

```
service dovecot start
chkconfig --level 235 dovecot on
```

Test the POP connectivity:

```
[root@sastratechnologies.in sridhar]# telnet localhost 110
Trying ::1...
Connected to localhost.
Escape character is '^A'.
+OK Dovecot ready.
quit
+OK Logging out
Connection closed by foreign host.
```

The going is good and though the server is ready to receive mails, we are yet to create users. So let's do so now.

Install and configure SpamAssassin

SpamAssassin is an email spam filter that uses DNS-based fuzzy logic, Bayesian filtering and several other methods for spam detection. To install it, run the following command in your terminal:

```
yum install spamassassin
```

Open the SpamAssassin configuration file as follows:

```
nano /etc/mail/spamassassin/local.cf
```

You should see the following entries in the file:

```
required_hits 5
report_safe 0
rewrite_header Subject [SPAM]
```

The *required_hits* determines the intensity of the filter. The lower the score, the higher the filter aggression. For a start-up organisation, you could set it at 5. Higher values will let more incoming mails to pass through.

The *report_safe* parameter determines whether the incoming mail is delivered to the intended recipient after being flagged as 'spam' or trashed. If you want all spam to be trashed mercilessly, use a value of '1'. Otherwise, use '0', in which case mails that are appended with a spam notice in the subject line are still sent to the recipient's inbox.

The rewrite header specifies the text that is appended to the subject line of any mail that is flagged as spam. In our case, we'll have [SPAM] appended to our subject line. You could also use ***** if you wish to draw the recipient's attention.

Let's add another parameter *required_score*, which sets the score for all emails allowed through to your domain. A score of 0 will classify the email as legitimate, while a score of 5 will classify an email as definite SPAM. Let's set it to 3, which will let us trap a few unsolicited mails but will also flag a few false positives.

```
required_score 5
```

SpamAssassin relies on two UNIX daemon processes to work correctly – *spamd* and *spamc*. *Spamd* waits for new email to arrive—once it receives an incoming connection it spawns the *spamc* daemon to read the email from the respective socket. *Spamc* reads the email and once it encounters an EOF, it will pass the message to *spamd*. *Spamd* will then rewrite the message based on your spam rules, e.g., it may rewrite the header with [SPAM] in the beginning and pass it back to *spamc*. The *spamc* daemon process then ends and Dovecot processes the incoming message.

Because of the nature of these daemon processes, we'll need to create a separate group and user for *spamd* to integrate with Postfix:

```
groupadd spamd
useradd -g spamd -s /bin/false -d /var/log/spamassassin spamd
chown spamd:spamd /var/log/spamassassin
```

Reconfigure Postfix to use SpamAssassin scripts:

```
nano /etc/postfix/master.cf
smtp inet n - n - - smtpd -o content_filter=spamassassin
```

Right at the bottom, include the following line:

```
spamassassin unix - n - - pipe flags=R user=spamd argv=/usr/bin/spamc -e /usr/sbin/sendmail -oi -f ${sender} ${recipient}
```

Before you start SpamAssassin, update the rules. From your terminal, execute the following command: